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KAARTHIKEYAN DID TWO THINGS AFTER THE DEATH-IN-CUSTODY episode. First, he tried to boost the morale of the team. He told the entire team that Sivarasan was feeling trapped—it was evident from his frequent SOS messages to Jaffna. One-Eyed Jack already knew that he could not keep the SIT off his tracks. It could also be that he was not feeling safe under the political group of the LTTE. Was he operating now on his own instead of depending on his handlers for movements? He understood that his fellow LTTE members were under the constant watch of the SIT and other security agencies. He didn't want to risk availing their protection any more. If ever there was a time, Kaarthikeyan told his team, to charge ahead full steam to catch Sivarasan, this was it.

Second, Kaarthikeyan requested the Tamil Nadu government to lodge all the accused in a regular prison. They were still being kept at Malligai. Although they were in handcuffs all the time and kept under the constant vigil of the CRPF and the CBI armed constables, he didn't want to take any chance after the Shanmugham incident.

The state government promptly agreed and allotted the Poonamallee sub-jail, twenty-five kilometres off Malligai, for keeping the accused. The entire route from Malligai to Poonamallee sub-jail was blocked to transfer the accused safely, which took almost a full day.

Three names had been appearing in the interrogation of Jayakumar, Robert Payas and Athirai—Vicky, Dixon and Suresh Master, all of whom worked under Trichy Santhan. It was established that the political group of the LTTE was in control of the post-assassination 'escape' operation, since the job of the INT group was over. The SIT was getting desperate to catch at least one of these three.